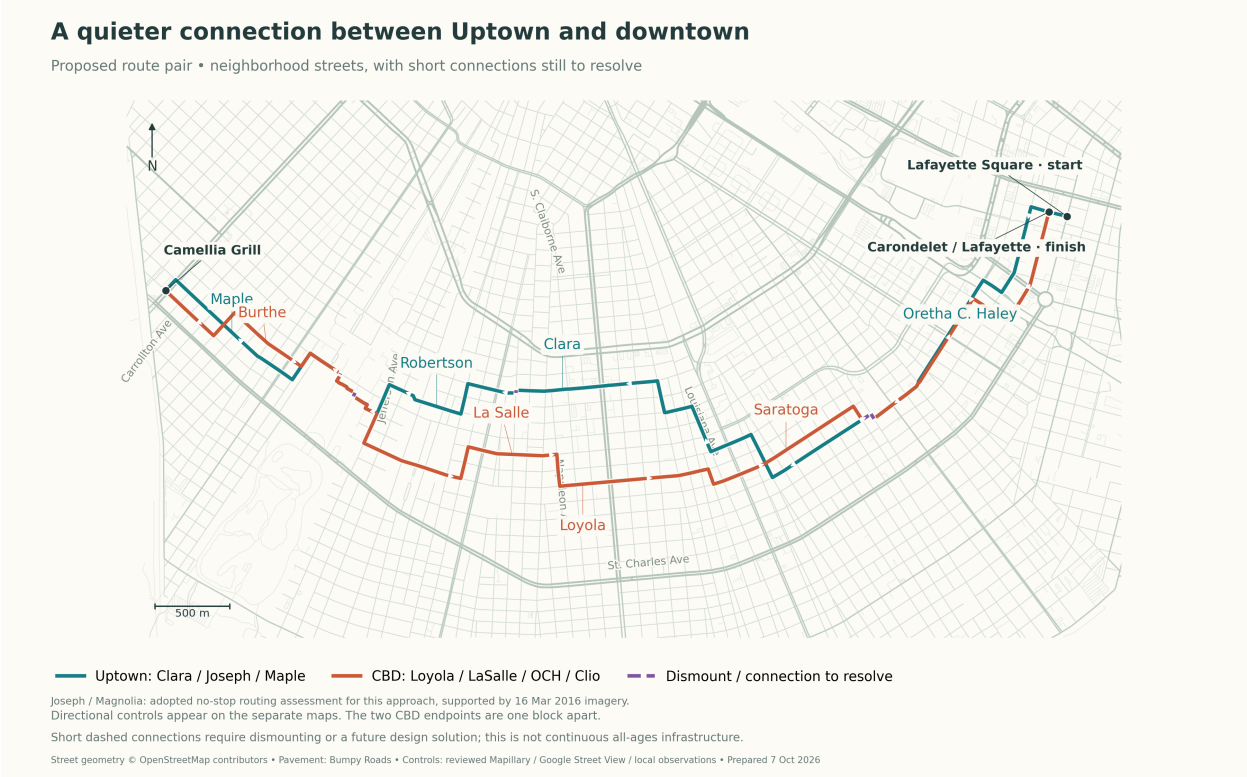
A quieter way between Uptown and Downtown

A pair of connected neighborhood bike boulevard corridors, from Lafayette Square to Camellia Grill.

Prioritize Clara - Joseph - Robertson toward Uptown and Loyola - LaSalle - Oretha Castle Haley toward Downtown. Leave Clara at Joseph to avoid busy State Street. Keep OCH on the return, then use Clio to reach Carondelet. Complete the short connections that interrupt these corridors, retaining the longer Valence-Carondelet alignment as a fewer-stop alternative.



The case: roughly 5.3-5.4 miles each way; approximately 24 minutes in this rider's e-bike scenario, or 24.3-25.5 minutes when the designated short links are walked. The proposal is to complete a coherent corridor; several connections still need field validation and design.

The recommended pair, with honest tradeoffs

Times are personal e-bike model estimates. Small differences are not reliable winners.

Corridor	Miles	Ride links min	Walk links min	Pavement[1]	Coverage[1]	STOPs Ord. / AW / ?	Signals
Clara / Joseph / Maple	5.38	24.1	24.3	2.44	92.1%	21 / 7 / 0	11
Loyola / LaSalle / OCH / Clio	5.27	23.9	25.5	2.34	92.0%	28 / 3 / 0	9
Robertson / Maple	5.20	23.6	23.7	2.51	93.2%	27 / 2 / 0	10
Valence / Carondelet	5.51	24.1	24.5	2.46	95.5%	15 / 5 / 2	9
Clara / Joseph / Hampson	5.51	25.0	25.2	2.19	92.2%	26 / 7 / 0	11
Baronne / Loyola · direct	5.28	23.3	23.4	3.42	94.0%	18 / 5 / 1	9
Danneel / Loyola · direct	5.13	22.5	22.5	2.88	93.4%	14 / 5 / 0	10
Danneel / Loyola · LaSalle jog	5.36	23.6	23.7	2.55	93.2%	18 / 4 / 0	10

[1] Lower Bumpy Roads sensor index means smoother measured pavement; it is not IRI. Coverage includes unmeasured campus riding and excludes walking links. AW = supported all-way. ? = known STOP, all-way status unassessed; timed conservatively as ordinary.

Why keep the recommended pair?

Clara / Joseph retains the smoother main corridor: 2.44 versus 2.88 for direct Danneel/Loyola. It also has 6 fewer ordinary stops and 5 more all-way stops than Robertson.

Loyola / OCH / Clio keeps the preferred return, with 54% two-way motor-street riding. Its jog is Octavia → LaSalle → Valence → Loyola.

Read the timing scenarios separately

Danneel / Loyola is the fastest current modeled option, with rougher pavement. Its LaSalle jog trades about 69 seconds for a smoother route.

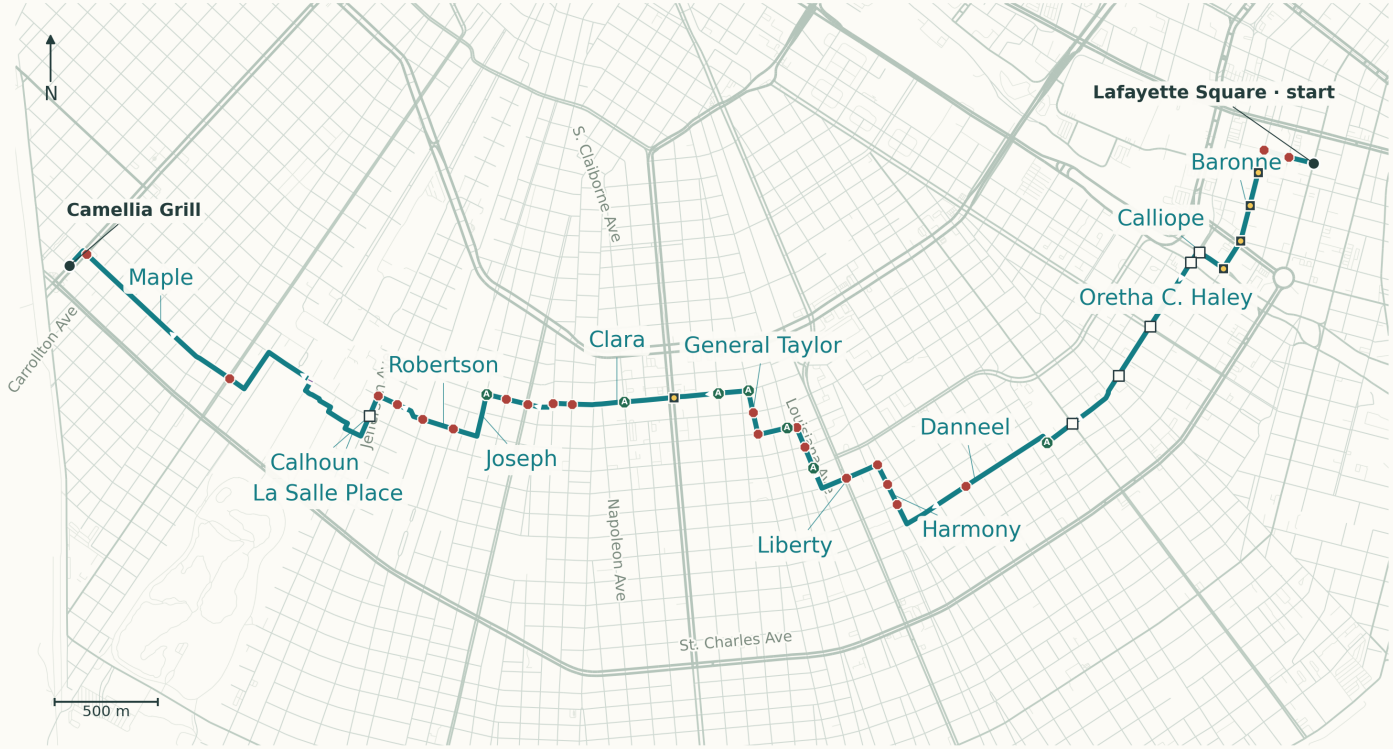
Walk-link times use 1.2 m/s; both scenarios assume 3 m/s on campus and omit unsurveyed access/crossing delays. Riding-pace assumptions do not change mapped directions or access. The new outbound options have only the existing short Law Road walk link.

Uptown: Clara / Joseph / Maple

Lafayette Square → Harmony → Liberty → Clara → Joseph → Robertson → campus → Maple

CBD → Uptown | Stops and signals

Clara / Joseph / Maple • 5.38 mi • 21 ordinary + 7 all-way stops • 11 lights (6 inferred)



Joseph / Magnolia: adopted no-stop routing assessment for this approach, supported by 16 Mar 2016 imagery.
Markers count encounters on this route and direction only—not a citywide sign inventory. Dated evidence is not a current field survey.

Short dashed connections require dismounting or a future design solution; this is not continuous all-ages infrastructure.

Street geometry © OpenStreetMap contributors • Pavement: Bumpy Roads • Controls: reviewed Mapillary / Google Street View / local observations • Prepared 7 Oct 2026

State is crossed on Robertson, with no longitudinal riding. Joseph/Magnolia is treated as no STOP, using the March 16, 2016 imagery assessment accepted by the rider. Controls are directional. Short walk links stay marked; the Soniat sidewalk maneuver needs an on-site check.

Downtown: Loyola / LaSalle / OCH

Camellia Grill → campus → Loyola → LaSalle jog → Saratoga → First → OCH → Clio → Carondelet

Uptown → CBD | Stops and signals

Loyola / LaSalle / OCH / Clio • 5.27 mi • 28 ordinary + 3 all-way stops • 9 lights (0 inferred)



Markers count encounters on this route and direction only—not a citywide sign inventory. Dated evidence is not a current field survey.

Short dashed connections require dismounting or a future design solution; this is not continuous all-ages infrastructure.

Street geometry © OpenStreetMap contributors • Pavement: Bumpy Roads • Controls: reviewed Mapillary / Google Street View / local observations • Prepared 7 Oct 2026

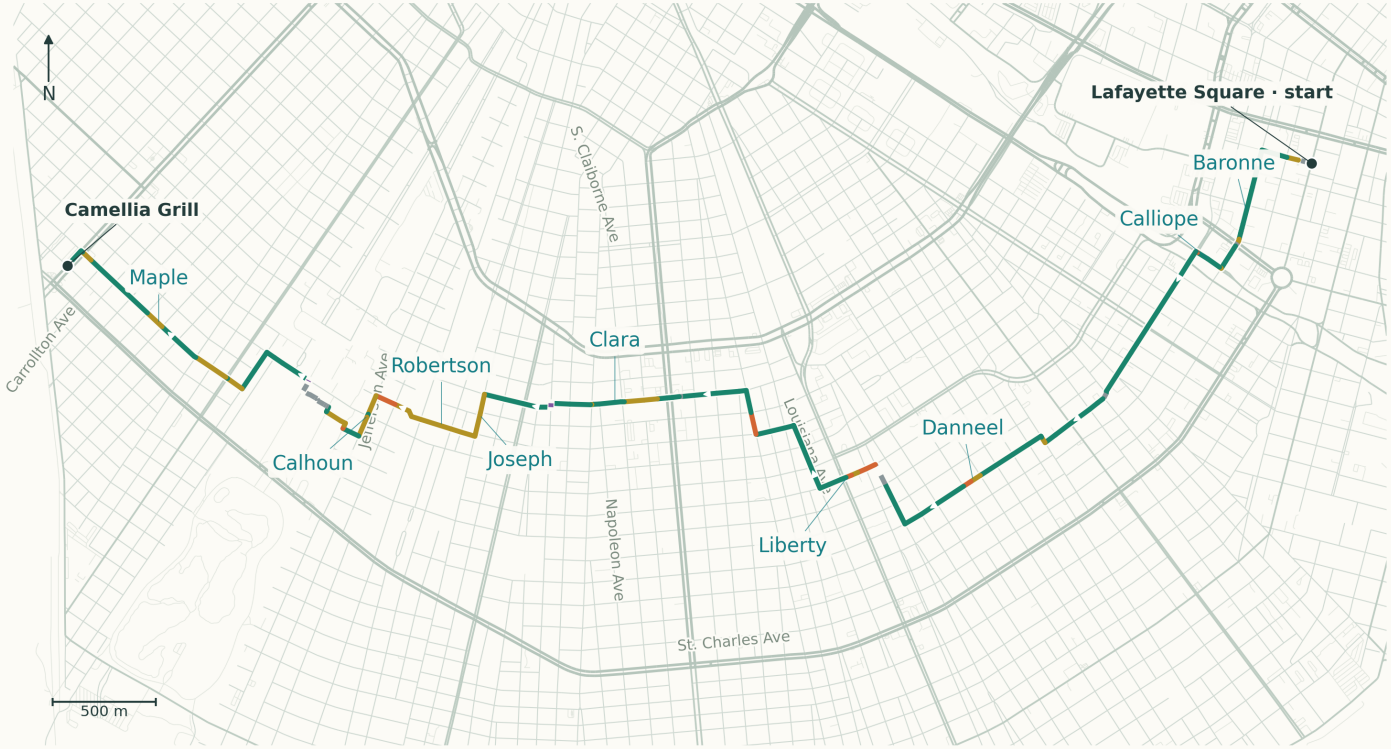
Keep the OCH corridor, then turn onto Clio to reach Carondelet. The Clio approaches at Baronne and Carondelet have rider-confirmed STOP presence. The crossing streets have clear approaches, so these are ordinary stops. Finish at Carondelet/Lafayette, avoiding Poydras.

Pavement toward Uptown

Clara / Joseph / Maple: measured index 2.44; 92.1% riding-distance coverage

CBD → Uptown | Pavement

Clara / Joseph / Maple • 5.38 mi • measured roughness 2.44 • 92.1% riding coverage



Joseph / Magnolia: adopted no-stop routing assessment for this approach, supported by 16 Mar 2016 imagery.
Bumpy Roads scale; lower is smoother. Coverage denominator excludes dismount links. Campus paths lack measured readings.

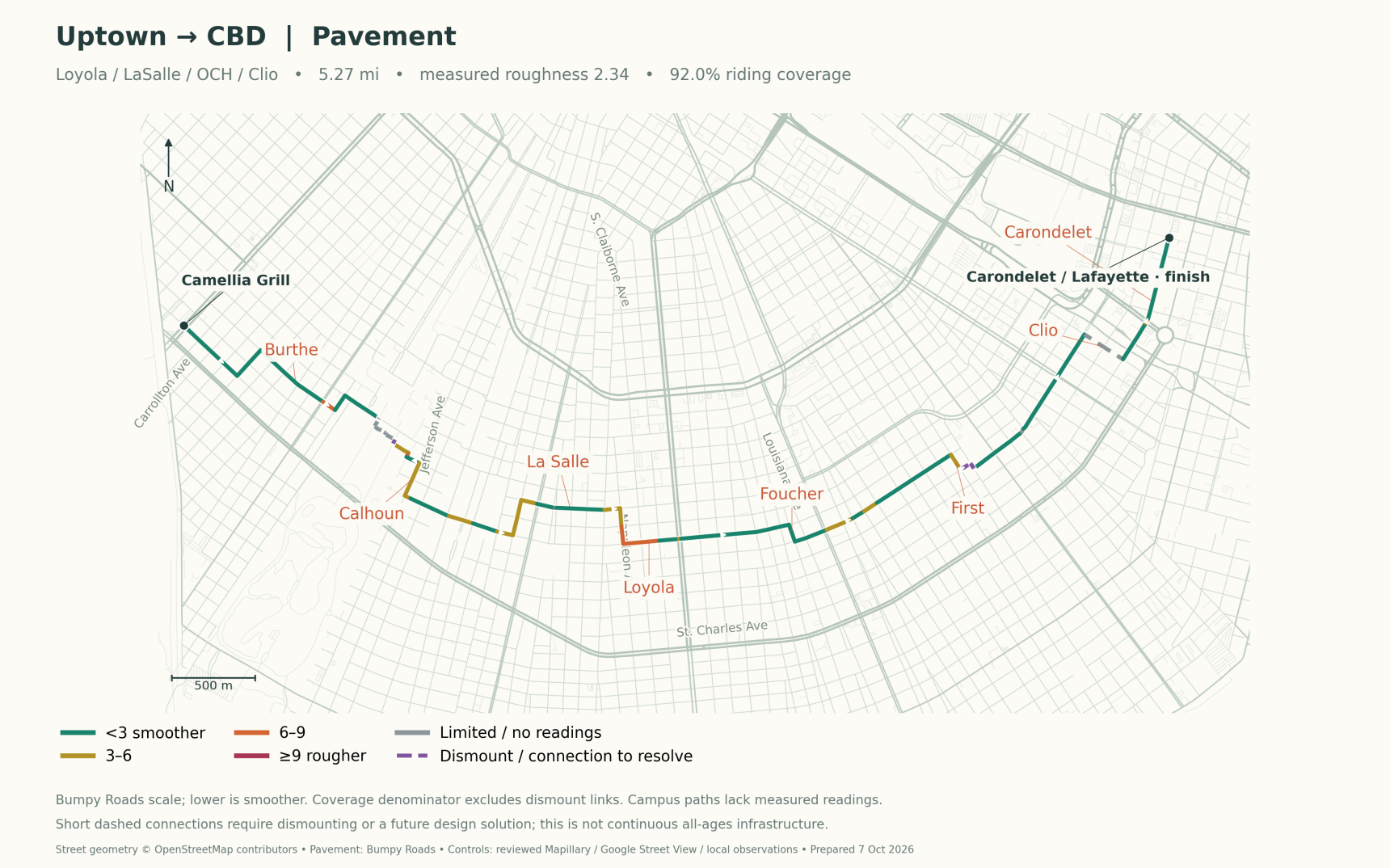
Short dashed connections require dismounting or a future design solution; this is not continuous all-ages infrastructure.

Street geometry © OpenStreetMap contributors • Pavement: Bumpy Roads • Controls: reviewed Mapillary / Google Street View / local observations • Prepared 7 Oct 2026

Color describes measured roughness, not traffic safety. Missing measurements stay visibly distinct. The campus link is unmeasured, including about 46 m mapped as gravel; its surface must not be inferred from the adjacent streets.

Pavement toward Downtown

Loyola / LaSalle / OCH / Clio: measured index 2.34; 92.0% riding-distance coverage



The longer Valence-Carondelet alternative reduces ordinary stops. On the outbound route, the Hampson finish improves measured pavement at the cost of distance and stops. Readings are aggregated and do not reliably establish lane or direction-specific conditions. The map includes all current options.

Why these streets rose to the top

The preferred boulevard balances continuity, pavement, quietness and crossings.

Clara / Joseph versus Robertson

The State-free Clara route has a modest pavement advantage: measured index 2.44 versus 2.51. Its stronger case is 6 fewer confirmed ordinary stops and 5 more supported all-way stops, for about 27 additional model seconds. Robertson avoids the Clara/Soniat walking link and remains the simpler timing alternative.

Loyola, then the LaSalle jog

Loyola fits the preference for riding along two-way streets. The exact jog is **Octavia** → **LaSalle** → **Valence** → **Loyola**, then Foucher → Saratoga → First. Loyola is not all-way at every junction: Robert traffic has no stop, so Loyola/Robert does not earn an all-way comfort benefit.

Valence and Carondelet

Stay on Valence from LaSalle to Carondelet for the fewer-stop alternative. It has 15 confirmed ordinary, 5 all-way and 2 unassessed STOPs. Timing treats 17 as ordinary, versus 28 on OCH/Clio. Carondelet has more one-way riding and a streetcar-rail tradeoff. The primary return keeps OCH and uses Carondelet only for the CBD finish.

Baronne and Danneel into Loyola

Baronne → Amelia → Loyola: 23.3 model minutes, pavement index 3.42. One STOP has unassessed all-way status.

Danneel → Amelia → Loyola: 22.5 minutes, index 2.88, 14 ordinary and 5 all-way stops. It is faster, but includes about 365 m classified very rough, versus 26 m on Clara.

Danneel with the LaSalle jog: Valence → LaSalle → Joseph → Loyola gives 23.6 minutes and index 2.55. All three use legal outbound Palmer riding and the same campus/Maple finish. The clock model does not include a fitted pavement penalty.

Smoother endings and street exclusions

Hampson lowers Clara's measured index to 2.19, adding about 53 seconds and 5 ordinary stops. The earlier Willow return used State, so it remains excluded pending a separate connection.

No longitudinal State, Napoleon or Louisiana; crossing State is allowed. Freret is limited to university connections. Poydras and parking-aisle shortcuts are excluded; wide Marengo is deprioritized.

The original 69 geometries and 16 then-eligible routes remain historical research. The current options incorporate the State correction and requested Loyola alternatives; no citywide optimum is claimed.

What a stop actually costs

Elapsed delay includes slowing, any waiting, and acceleration inside the measured section.

Matched encounter	Extra time	Pairs
Ordinary STOP, all passage types	3.7 sec	111
Supported all-way STOP	1.8 sec	39
Signal, including green passages	4.0 sec	199
Clear stop / near-stop subset[1]	16.7 sec	9

[1] The nine stopping passages include ordinary, all-way and unclassified STOPs. Median extra time: 12.5 sec. Detection required at least two seconds at or below 0.5 m/s plus GPS quality checks; it does not prove a legally complete stop. This is a strict subset, not a count of all stops in the history.

The 34-second example

For that stopped subset, the same-length **120 m section took 33.9 seconds with a stop versus 17.1 seconds without a control**. The extra time is 16.7 seconds; 33.9 seconds is total section time.

Only four of seven cases with adequate outer samples reached 90% of entry speed in the final 20 m. The window may miss some recovery, but a changed chosen pace can also explain a lower exit speed.

Two-way crossings take more time

For ordinary STOPs, matched passages crossing a verified one-way street averaged **+1.8 sec** (22 pairs); crossing two-direction traffic averaged **+4.4 sec** (80 pairs). The difference was about **2.5 sec**, with a day-bootstrap 95% interval of 1.6-3.7 sec.

Width, traffic and junction layout also differ. This is an association, not an isolated causal penalty for two-way streets. It does not conflict with preferring to *ride along* a quiet two-way street.

The earlier 34-second route comparison

Before the Clio revision, the Valence-Carondelet return added 511 m versus Loyola/OCH: about **75 seconds** at the model road pace. Ten fewer stops treated as ordinary saved **44 seconds**; two more all-way stops added **4 seconds**. The net was about 34 seconds, not 34 seconds per STOP.

The frozen route model uses 4.44 sec per ordinary STOP, 1.85 per all-way and 3.41 per signal. A sensitivity replacing these with matched-section means preserved the original shortlist's fastest routes; it was not a refit of this revised shortlist.

How the evidence was combined

A directional street graph, measured pavement, audited controls and one rider's recorded trips.

1. Build a connected, directional network

OpenStreetMap supplies geometry, incoming approaches, mapped access, one-way directions and turn restrictions. Bike Streets supplies the community low-stress network and construction context. Each direction is evaluated independently; reversing the outbound route is not a valid return plan.

2. Put pavement on the correct street

The Bumpy Roads snapshot contains **34,004 cells and 145,712 readings**. Its combined index is the geometric mean of calibrated MAD and LPC vibration scores.

Cells are assigned within 20 m of a street with a 4 m separation from competitors. Routes are sampled at intervals no greater than 7 m, using an assigned cell within 18 m. A distance-weighted mean prevents frequently recorded blocks from dominating. Unknown pavement receives a conservative search penalty; reported measured averages never fill it with invented smoothness.

3. Assign controls to the approach

Mapillary detections are candidates, not final truth. Bearings, geometry and imagery decide which incoming direction a sign controls. Google Street View and rider observations resolve missed signs, obscured corners and all-way questions. Repeated heads are grouped where evidence supports one crossing.

4. Learn personal elapsed time

The export has **306 rides and 254,703 GPS fixes**; 304 rides were complete and two incomplete. The typical interval is about one second, with median reported accuracy near 3 m and the 90th percentile near 11 m.

The main fit uses 1,433 suitable approximately 200 m windows from 176 rides on 95 days, covering 296 km. It preserves stopped time and compares held-out days, rather than randomly mixing samples from the same trip.

5. Check the stop result directly

The follow-up comparison pairs equal 120 m sections on the same ride, street and direction, close in time and with similar measured pavement. It excludes turns, neighboring controls and unknown approaches; reference sections have affirmative clear evidence. Separate 80-200 m tests check sensitivity to section length.

6. Keep time and comfort separate

The selected timing model uses distance and controls. Pavement did not improve held-out prediction enough to remain in that model; that does not show roughness has no cost. Pavement, stop clusters, two-way riding and all-way comfort remain explicit preferences. A comfort benefit never turns a physical stop into negative elapsed time.

How much time does quietness cost?

Historical scenario comparison; the quiet baseline predates the State and Clio revisions.

Illustrative pace / delay scenario	St. Charles Uptown	Quiet Uptown[2]	St. Charles CBD	Quiet CBD[2]
Fitted road pace; 3.4 sec per light	21.5 min	23.6 min	21.3 min	23.6 min
Same pace; 8 sec per light	23.4 min	23.6 min	23.0 min	23.6 min
Same pace; 12 sec per light	25.1 min	23.6 min	24.5 min	23.6 min
31 km/h on avenue; 3.4 sec per light	17.6 min	23.6 min	17.6 min	23.6 min

[2] These frozen comparators are the original Robertson/Maple outbound and Loyola/OCH return via O'Keefe/Girod. They document the earlier comparison. St. Charles assumptions vary while those quiet baselines stay fixed. Current route times are on page 2.

What the comparison supports

In that original baseline scenario, with fitted road pace, 3.4 sec per signal encounter and no extra unknown-control delay, quietness cost about **two minutes each way**. Larger average signal delays, including slowdown and recovery, could erase or reverse that gap.

Two recorded approximately 1.3 km stretches show around 31 km/h elapsed speed on St. Charles. They do not establish that speed over the whole corridor. The faster scenario could imply roughly six minutes of quiet-route premium, but has much less support.

Why this is not the preferred boulevard

St. Charles has more major-road exposure and signal variability. Its audit uses 25 outbound and 22 return signal encounters, but retains 61 and 60 unresolved approach events. Baseline scenarios add no extra delay at those unknowns; they are not verified clear.

A City notice schedules work in the 5400-5700 blocks from September 15 through approximately October 16, 2026, weather permitting. The scenarios exclude construction delay. Return geometry uses Howard/Carondelet to respect the CBD one-way section. [6]

Turn the preferred alignment into a boulevard

The practical pitch is a corridor-completion project, supported by evidence and local knowledge.

Priority	Concrete work
1 Complete the short links	Resolve Clara/Soniat and establish a comfortable lawful link through First-Danneel-Philip to OCH. The revised outbound uses Joseph/Robertson/Calhoun, removing State and the Palmer walking connection.
2 Agree the campus connection	Confirm permitted access, hours and pedestrian expectations for Law Road, campus paths, West Road and LaSalle Place. Measure the unrecorded surface, including the gravel section.
3 Make the major crossings legible	Review Napoleon, Louisiana, Freret and Carrollton crossing movements in the field. Assess whether crossing assistance, refuge, visibility or other treatments are appropriate; the ride model does not establish design warrants.
4 Fix the surface where it matters	Use the pavement map to locate harsh patches and missing readings. Measure the intended direction before promising a continuous smooth route; retain the State-free Hampson finish as a smoother option.
5 Refresh and publish the evidence	Check inferred signals and remaining unassessed all-way statuses. Retain the approach-specific evidence for the new Joseph and Clio connections. Prepare any OSM review separately, then check how Bike Streets imports controls. No OSM control edits were made in this study.
6 Test a signed, understandable route	After connections and permissions are resolved, trial wayfinding and repeat paired rides in both directions. Record end-to-end elapsed time, crossing delay and rider comfort at different times of day.

Decision requested: advance Clara-Joseph-Robertson and Loyola-LaSalle-OCH-Clio as the preferred corridor pair for field validation and connection design; preserve Robertson and Valence-Carondelet as alternatives. This report does not estimate construction cost, certify all-ages suitability or prescribe new STOP control without an engineering review.

What the investigation changed

Local corrections were retained as evidence, then the routes were rerun against the combined record.

The brief became more specific

The initial objective was smooth pavement between the CBD and Camellia Grill. The final brief added strong quiet-street preference, ordinary-stop annoyance, a benefit for supported all-way stops and a preference for riding on two-way streets.

The rider's State Street correction removed longitudinal State riding. Clara now exits at Joseph for Robertson/Calhoun. On the return, OCH stays; Clio replaces O'Keefe/Girod as the connection to Carondelet. Napoleon, most Freret, parking-aisle shortcuts and Poydras remain excluded; wide Marengo is deprioritized.

Local knowledge changed junction evidence

Examples include Saratoga stopping at Louisiana, General Taylor and Napoleon; Octavia/Magnolia being all-way; Robert having no stop at Loyola; and no Maple STOP at Cherokee in the queried direction. Loyola/Robert therefore remains an ordinary crossing despite Loyola's stops.

All-way status was checked by looking at the other approaches, not only for an ALL WAY plaque. An unconfirmed plaque or a nearby detected sign is insufficient to declare the entire junction all-way.

The tool and model evolved

A route editor and options map made the tradeoffs inspectable. Historic GPS then supplied personal timing rather than invented stop penalties. Equal-length section matching checked braking and recovery directly, and the St. Charles comparison tested how much quietness might cost.

Connections missing from Bike Streets blue lines

The October 2 tile comparison identified these candidate additions:

Loyola Milan-Foucher + Foucher to Saratoga: about 541 m combined.
Harmony Danneel-Liberty + Liberty to Delachaise: about 613 m; Liberty has mixed pavement.
Clara General Taylor-State: roughly 1.5 km in the historical audit, with the Soniat caveat. The current route leaves earlier, at Joseph.
LaSalle Delachaise-Jena + Jena to Robertson: about 995 m; Jena is rougher.

The campus "gap" was a shortcut

The newly mapped approximately 70 m path chain saves about 104 m against an existing approximately 174 m blue-network loop. It is an omitted shorter connection, not proof that the two sides were completely disconnected.

OCH was already on the blue network; some apparent gaps were line offsets or overlapping layer assignments. A missing blue line is a mapping finding, not automatic evidence that a street should be endorsed.

The source snapshots, rider corrections and photo audits remain in the project. Raw personal GPS traces and API credentials are excluded from this pitch package.

The complete recommended street sequences

These name the corridor and short connections. Consult the interactive map for geometry and approach controls.

Uptown / Clara-Joseph

CBD to Harmony

Lafayette → Baronne → Calliope → OCH → Philip → Danneel → Harmony.

Reach and follow Clara

South Liberty → Delachaise → South Robertson → General Taylor → Clara → Soniat connection → Clara → Joseph.

University connection

South Robertson → Calhoun → LaSalle Place → campus lane → West Road → campus path → Law Road.

Finish at Camellia

Freret → Audubon → Maple → South Carrollton. The mapped finish is near the restaurant at Hampson/Carrollton; the final entrance approach is separate.

Short links retain their original WALK BIKE designation. The time scenarios change the assumed pace, not mapped permissions. Campus access and crossing conditions must be checked on site.

Downtown / Loyola-OCH-Clio

Camellia to campus

Hampson → Adams → Burthe → Audubon → Freret → Law Road → campus path → West Road → campus lane → LaSalle Place.

Loyola and the jog

Calhoun → Loyola → Octavia → LaSalle Street → Valence → Loyola.

Return to OCH

Foucher → South Saratoga → First → Danneel → Philip → OCH.

CBD finish

Clio → Carondelet to Lafayette Street (finish). OCH is retained; only its final CBD connection changes. Optional walking continuation to Lafayette Square is outside the modeled route.

Short links retain their original WALK BIKE designation. The time scenarios change the assumed pace, not mapped permissions. Campus access and crossing conditions must be checked on site.

Current options, and what was superseded

The original 69-route search remains the research record; the State restriction changes the shortlist.

Route / finish	Ride links min	Walk links min	Pavement	Coverage	Ord. / AW / ?	Signals
↑ Danneel / Amelia / Loyola → Maple	22.5	22.5	2.88	93.4%	14 / 5 / 0	10
↑ Baronne / Amelia / Loyola → Maple	23.3	23.4	3.42	94.0%	18 / 5 / 1	9
↑ Danneel / Loyola / LaSalle jog → Maple	23.6	23.7	2.55	93.2%	18 / 4 / 0	10
↑ Harmony / Liberty / Robertson → Maple	23.6	23.7	2.51	93.2%	27 / 2 / 0	10
↑ Clara / Joseph / Robertson → Maple	24.1	24.3	2.44	92.1%	21 / 7 / 0	11
↑ Clara / Joseph / Robertson → Hampson	25.0	25.2	2.19	92.2%	26 / 7 / 0	11
↓ Loyola / LaSalle / OCH / Clio / Carondelet	23.9	25.5	2.34	92.0%	28 / 3 / 0	9
↓ Valence / LaSalle / Carondelet	24.1	24.5	2.46	95.5%	15 / 5 / 2	9

↑ Uptown; ↓ Downtown. All current routes avoid riding along State. Crossing State remains allowed with the relevant approach control. STOP counts separate confirmed ordinary, supported all-way and known STOPs whose all-way status remains unassessed.

What changed after the original screen

The original search produced 69 geometries; 16 met its then-current rules. Earlier Clara/Palmer and Willow routes that rode along State are superseded.

The current set adds requested Baronne/Loyola and Danneel/Loyola choices, including a smoother LaSalle jog. Clara uses Joseph/Robertson/Calhoun, with Maple or Hampson endings.

What this table does not claim

This is a current design shortlist, not a new search over every street. Zero unresolved modeled control presence does not imply current field verification of every signal, all-way status or campus permission.

The primary return keeps OCH and uses Clio/Carondelet for its final CBD connection. Valence-Carondelet remains a distinct alternative.

Sources, evidence limits and the map package

September 30-October 2 source snapshots, with October 7 route corrections and rider confirmations.

What is strong, and what remains uncertain

The main routes have no unresolved modeled control-presence approaches. The rider accepted the Joseph/Magnolia no-stop assessment, supported by two March 16, 2016 Mapillary views. This records an accepted routing assessment; the imagery remains the observation source. Clio's two STOPs are rider-confirmed on October 7, 2026.

Clara/Joseph has 6 model-assigned signals and Loyola/OCH/Clio 0. Their STOPs with unassessed all-way status number 0 and 0. The revised return avoids O'Keefe/Girod.

Held-out sections had 31.9 sec mean absolute error after aggregation within each ride; 25 contiguous sections at least 1 km long had 37 sec MAE. Neither validates complete five-mile journeys. Same-bike history reduces one source of variation; traffic, weather, intent and historic controls remain confounders. Roughness dates are absent from public tiles; 83% of cells have only one contributing bicycle. Fetch date is not measurement date.

Scope of the maps

Markers describe encounters along the plotted direction, not a census of every stop sign in Uptown. Some pedestrian and initial entry maneuvers sit outside the incoming road-approach tally. Current site conditions take priority over historical photos.

The interactive map separates ordinary, all-way and unassessed STOPs, signals and pavement. Selecting alternatives reveals their exact alignments and evidence. Static maps remain usable without web tiles.

Source index

[1] Bumpy Roads pavement
Public community tile snapshot, 30 September 2026; index implementation checked in the project repository.

[2] OpenStreetMap
Street geometry and mapped directions. © OpenStreetMap contributors; ODbL.

[3] Bike Streets New Orleans
Community network tiles checked 2 October; private ride export used only for aggregated analysis.

[4] Mapillary
Machine detections plus dated imagery, with direction assignment and manual review.

[5] Google Street View
Dated approach review, combined with recorded rider confirmations. Evidence links retained in map data.

[6] City St. Charles advisory
September 11 notice, checked October 7; scheduled work through approximately October 16.

Companion files: interactive-map.html; report.html; selected-route-cues.txt; research-facts.json; control-evidence-audit.json. The dated approach evidence is maintained in the project's traffic-controls.sqlite database.

No credentials or raw ride histories are included. No OSM edits were performed. This report and its public map contain aggregate analysis and corridor evidence.